MUSIC ▼

ROCK AND ROLL RENEGADE

TOM MORELLO BRINGS A STANDOUT YEAR OF MUSIC AND TOURING TO INDIA WITH A SERIES OF CAREER-SPANNING SHOWS



Despite the tumultuous times in his home country, American rock guitarist, composer and singer-songwriter Tom Morello—best known for his bands Rage Against The Machine and Audioslave—has had a pretty good year. He was the musical director of heavy metal pioneers Black Sabbath's farewell concert in Birmingham; he scored the musical *Revolution(s)*, staged in his home city of Chicago; and he's been recording and touring with his younger son, teenage guitar prodigy Roman.

The Grammy-winning artist will cap 2025 by playing career-spanning shows in Bengaluru, Gurugram and Mumbai this month, as part of the inaugural set of the Bandland on Tour series of concerts promoted and produced by BookMyShow Live.

For him, they're all high points but sharing the stage with his kid is extra-special. "I really love having my family on tour and rocking with my son, it's so much fun," says Morello, who will be joined in India by Roman as well as his long-standing band The Freedom Fighter Orchestra, and older son Rhoads, assistant lighting director for his gigs.

MORELLO HAS NEVER FELT LIKE TONING DOWN HIS STANCE TO APPEAL TO A WIDER AUDIENCE

As an American, Morello, who is fiercely outspoken about his political views, enjoys more freedom of speech than in some of the places where his biggest fans reside. For them, his songs—such as RATM's 'Bulles on Parade' and 'Killing In The Name Of'—provide outlets to express things they can't say without fear of serious repercussions. "That's one of the great powers of music," he says. "It can transcend borders with ideas that can be subversive while being acceptable."

Morello has never felt like toning down his stance to appeal to a wider audience. He did try it at the start of his career, as part of the 1980s band Lock Up. "We wanted to be rock stars and did everything the managers, the record company, the producers asked us to do," he recalls. "The music got softer, smoother, less experimental, and we were dropped from our label." It's then that he made a "solemn vow to never play another note that I didn't believe in". Ever since, that's been his "north star". ■

—Amit Gurbaxani

Morello** will perform in **Gurugram on Dec. 17, Mumbai on Dec. 19, and Bengaluru on Dec. 21

CINEMA ▶

RISING STAR

YASHASVI JUYAL'S *THE LAST RHODODENDRON* IS A POETIC SHORT FILM ABOUT MIGRATION AND MOTHERHOOD IN THE HILLS OF UTTARAKHAND

Yashasvi Juyal has already made his first feature film. Co-produced by film critic Anupama Chopra and many others, *The Ink-Stained Hand and the Missing Thumb* is yet to see

In *Holy Curse*, an androgynous adolescent finds herself forced to submit to a ritual to "cure" her queerness. Astutely written and directed by US-based Indian filmmaker Snigdha Kapoor, the short film, available on *The New Yorker*'s YouTube channel, is hoping to make the Oscar shortlist in the Best Live Action Short Film category.



CULTURAL LENS Adithi Kalkunte and Mrunal Kashid in *Holy Curse*